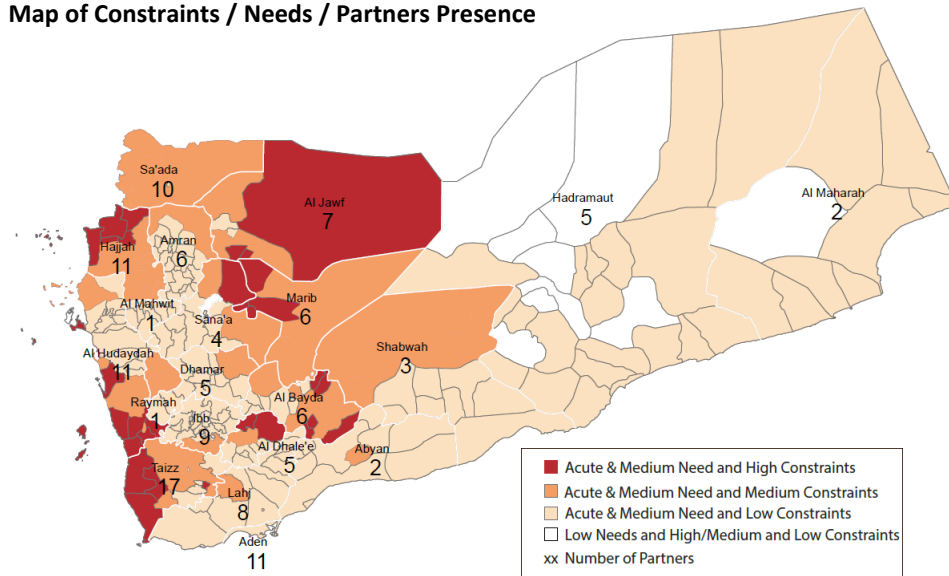




General Context

Over the month the warplanes continue to intensify their airstrikes and new ground offensives undertaken by the parties to the conflict leave ever increasing casualties and wounded, in addition to contributing to worsening the humanitarian needs of the Yemeni people and negatively affecting the Cluster Partners reach to beneficiaries due to access and security constraints.

Map of Constraints / Needs / Partners Presence



In Ibb hub: Although the fighting in Taizz Governorate calmed down a bit compared to February, the security situation remains challenging in Taizz city and the 4 Northern districts which remain inaccessible. The ongoing efforts by the Government to establish NAMCHA (National Authority for the Management and Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs and Disaster Recovery) affected the implementation of projects, including delays in getting the necessary clearances, resulting in the suspension or delay of activities. In the southern part of Taizz, a new Relief Committee was established which has so far played a positive role in facilitating Partners activities.

In Al Hudaydah hub, there were new displacements from the frontlines mainly in Hays (Al Hudaydah), Nihm (Sana'a) and Midi (Hajjah) to other districts in Al Hudaydah, Al Mahwit and Hajjah Governorates. The main challenge encountered was the lack of a preparedness plan for the massive flow of displacement and increased access constraints for NGOs. The total number of displaced persons since January reached 7,000 IDP families.

In Sana'a hub, There has been increased vulnerability among the host community in Amran Governorate leading to hostility against IDPs as humanitarian assistance mainly targets IDPs. This represents a protection risk for IDPs relating to access to basic services and social interaction with the host community. The new landlord in Al-Maardh IDP hosting site in Raydah district, hosting some marginalized *Muhamasheen* families, has requested them to vacate his land. The local authorities and NAMCHA representatives and other stakeholders are working together to find solutions as this is becoming a worrying trend.

In Sa'adah hub, The humanitarian and security situation continues to deteriorate. The new frontlines at the border districts of Sa'ada and Khab Wa Ash Sha'af district (Al Jawf) resulted in increasing the waves of displacement to neighboring districts. In late March airstrikes intensified mainly in Sa'adah Governorate with increased cross-border attacks which resulted in indiscriminate damage to the properties of civilians, loss of life and increased fear among the population.

In Aden and Al Mukala hubs, 996 IDP families have been displaced mainly from Al Hudaydah and Taizz during March due to the ongoing conflict in both Governorates which has increased the total IDP figure to 9,030 IDP families. Some IDPs have chosen to displace east to Hadramout and Al Maharah Governorates seeking better livelihood opportunities and affordable cost of living.

KEY FIGURES

Total population in need

5.4 million

Total population with acute needs

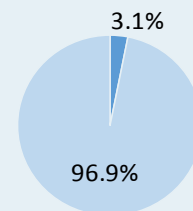
2.6 million

Cluster targeted population

3 million

Population assisted

226,932



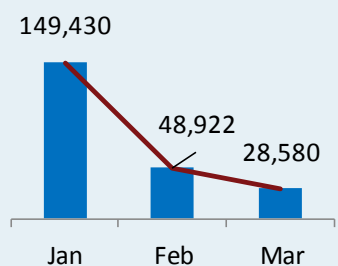
Total funding required:

\$ 195 M

■ Funded

■ Gap

PEOPLE ASSISTED MONTHLY TREND



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Recent Situational Developments

The National Shelter/NFI/CCCM Cluster organized two meetings: a general meeting held on 11th of March focused mainly on Al Hudaydah and Taizz displacement and response, the HPF 2018 Allocations and the response in IDPs hosting sites. An ad-hoc meeting was dedicated to discuss the Cluster strategy for the HPF 2018 Allocations and presented the methodology and best practices from an ACTED pilot project in Ibb which supports the beneficiaries shelter longer term shelter solutions. The Cluster Coordination Team (CCT) was on mission in Al Hudaydah and Hajjah Governorates to support the Sub National Cluster Coordination in the hub. Meetings were held with the Heads of NAMCHA in the two Governorates to strengthen cooperation and collaboration and enlist support for improved coordination in the Governorates. A visit was also made to Durian AlSufla spontaneous settlement located in Abs district, Hajjah Governorate where UNHCR constructed 4,000 transitional shelters for the most vulnerable IDPs in the site. The purpose of the visit was to assess the situation of the site residents and hear their voices and views.

The National Shelter/NFI/CCCM Cluster also organized a second capacity building session on the 14th of March attended by 22 participants from the Cluster Partners to introduce writing better project proposals using the Pooled Fund proposal a practical example and the techniques of the Monitoring & Evaluation. The session was facilitated by National Cluster Partners Grassroot and CSSW. On the 20th of March, the CCT facilitated a training on Site Management and Coordination with participation of 21 staff from Cluster Partners identified to provide the support in 44 pilot IDPs hosting sites for the integrated approach working towards improving their living situation. Four priority Technical Working Groups (TWiG) were established to support the development of capacity building strategy, complaints and feedback mechanisms, support the response in IDPs hosting sites and review and finalize the Cash for Shelter guidelines and tools.

Sub-National Cluster Coordinator (SNCC) in Ibb hub; undertook monitoring visits to Al Mashanah district (Ibb) to oversee the relocation process for the project being implemented by ACTED targeting IDPs in AlSabahi school. The main observation was that IDPs do not feel they will continue to receive service and assistance after they move out to the new relocated locations resulting in reticence to be relocated. A field visit was also made to the first NFI distribution conducted by UNHCR through their implementing partner YWU (Yemen Women Union) in Maqbanah district (Taizz) in over a year due to the security situation. It was observed that there were no complaints and feedback mechanism in place during the distribution and issues raised related to the accuracy of the beneficiary lists. The Sub-National Cluster also organized their monthly meeting on the 6th of March which discussed new displacements in Ibb and Taizz, Partners capacity and the IDPs relocations. The SNCC attended the Regional Coordination Team (RCT) meeting as well as WASH, GBV, Education and Health Sub-National Clusters meetings to discuss cross-cutting issues such as the figures of new displacements, relocation of IDPs from schools and ways to address gaps in the response.

SNCC In Taizz; armed conflict remains one of the biggest challenges contributing to access restrictions which affect the movement of organizations staff and materials as well as the overall reach to the affected population. The SNCC attended two meetings held in the presence of the focal points in Al Mafeer district, Ash Shamayateen district and the humanitarian coordination team in Taizz governorate that discussed the challenges that IDPs are facing in schools. The outcome of the meetings highlighted the importance of working closely with local authorities to find alternative shelter solutions for the IDPs and strengthen the collaboration on Site Management and Coordination. The Sub-National Cluster organized their monthly meeting on 27th March to discuss IDP needs in collective centers and displacement in Taizz. Generally, it was observed that Protection issues needs to be given more attention particularly in collective centers as families were resorting to negative coping strategies. BCFHD (Bena Charity for Humanitarian Development) has completed an assessment in As shamayateen district to assess IDP Shelter and NFI needs. There are two ongoing assessments; Masar and Al Mawred Foundations are assessing the damages of civilians houses in As Silw district; and My Freedom Organization for Youth Rights is assessing the needs of IDPs and returnees in Al Wazeiah and Mawza districts. IYCY and GWQ reported the situation of some IDP families who are currently living in open areas in Mawza district, in urgent need for shelter assistance. The families were displaced in November 2017 and they have not been provided with any type of assistance to date.

SNCC Al Hudaydah hub; there were new displacements from the conflict frontlines mainly in Hays (Al Hudaydah), Nihm (Sana'a) and Midi (Hajjah) to other districts in Al Hudaydah, Al Mahwit and Hajjah Governorates. The main challenges encountered are related to the lack of preparedness plan to provide response for a massive flow of displacement, lack of resources, limited capacity of National NGOs and access constrains mainly for International NGOs. The total number of displaced persons since January has reached to 7,000 IDP families including 2,720 families displaced in Al Khwkhah (Al Hudaydah) in-which the security assessment is still ongoing to determine if access is possible from Aden hub. NAMCHA office in Al Hudaydah is establishing an IDP camp in Zabid district (AlHudaydah) which is close to the conflict zones in Hays district. So far 50 tents has been erected and WASH facilities are planned with funds from the local authorities.

SNCC Sana'a hub; the Sub-National Cluster held the monthly meeting on the 29th March to discuss the response to 200 IDP families reported being displaced from Barat Al-Ana'an district, Al-Jawf Governorate to Harf Sufayn district, Amran governorate. YRCs, CARE and NAMCHA office in Amran agreed to conduct an assessment for the newly displaced persons in Harf Sufayn district. YRCs conducted needs assessment for three IDP hosting sites all in Huth district (Mafrak Wadih, Haradh and Al-Madhloumah) and the results revealed that the emergency shelters distributed to the families two years ago have been worn-out and the situation of the WASH facilities have deteriorated. The SNCC Sana'a hub also attended the RCT meeting on 28th of March 2018 which discussed the planned mission to Marib and the first HPF 2018 allocations.

SNCC Sa'adah hub; the Sub-National Cluster organized their monthly meeting on 20th of March and discussed the new displacement in the hub and gaps and shortcoming of the response. UNHCR through its implementing partner YARD have completed needs assessment in Khab Wa Ash Sha'af district, Al Jawf as well as in Al Matammah district, Al Jawf. NAMCHA focal point in Sa'adah reported that they are in process of developing more accurate IDPs database for all the districts in Sa'adah and the data will be shared with the humanitarian actors at a later stage to facilitate beneficiary identification.

SNCC Aden hub; The continuation of fighting in several frontlines over the month resulted in increased IDP figures with the majority of IDPs families choosing to settle in Abyan (4,087 families). The number of IDPs in Al Mukha district (Taizz) has increased by 298 IDP families as reported in Al Jumrah, Yakhtal, Al Ghurafi and Al thoubani areas. The Sub-National Cluster have held its monthly meeting on 4th of March and discussed displacement figures, Partners assessments, Response Plan and available resources and gaps. NMO (Nahdah Makers Organization) reported difficulties in obtaining the necessary clearances during the past three weeks for the planned distribution of the essential NFI kits in Mawza and Al-Waziziyah districts as the NAMCHA office in Taizz requested unusually detailed information about their project. UNHCR, IOM and other Cluster Partners carried out needs assessments for more than 3,600 IDP families in several districts of Aden, Shabwah (Beyhan district), Al-Mahrah and Lahj Governorates.

Response Overview

Assistance delivered and impact:

Taizz: 13, 252 individuals were assisted in March. NFIs distributions were completed by UNHCR through its implementing partner YWU in Maqbanh district for 209 families, IOM assisted 706 families (4,942 individuals) in Saber Al Moadem and Mawiah districts and NRC assisted 700 families (4,945 individuals) with in Al Mafeer district. NRC distributions mainly focused on IDPs who are living with host families ensuring that these families are more sustainably accommodated. NFI assistance were provided to families who displaced without any household items and the mats, kitchen sets mattresses etc ensured they could live with their families with some dignity. BCFHD distributed two out of six rounds of the cash assistance for rental subsidies to 200 families in Ash Shamyateen district. INTERSOS provided 72 families (504 individuals) with cash for rental subsidies in two districts Ash Shamyateen and Al Mafeer. Cash for shelter including rental subsidy provided the families with the option of staying longer in preferred shelter option and protect them from the indignity of being evicted with their families.

Al Hudaydah: DRC and UNHCR through its IP Jeel Al Bena Foundation distributed NFIs / EESKs to 521 families in Aljarrahi, Jabal Ras, AlSalah city and Al Mansory. These families on the move were provided the means to stop and find somewhere to call home temporarily.

Sa'adah: UNHCR through its IP YDF completed the distribution of 1,000 NFIs and 500 EESKs in Kitaf Wa AlBuqa district with the priority given to the most vulnerable families and those living in the open areas. These kits ensured that these families could find shelter in some kind families' private land to keep them safe temporarily until they find a longer term solution.

Al Jawf: UNHCR through its IP YARD distributed NFIs for 1,000 families (7,000 individuals) in Az Zahir district and 500 families (2, 500 individuals) were assisted with EESKs in Rajuzah district. The distributions targeted the most vulnerable newly displaced families and these kits prevented some down and out families from resorting to negative coping strategies that would destroy their family fabric

Abyan: IOM provided EESKs to 800 IDP families (5,600 individuals) in Khanfir district and 150 IDP families (1,050 individuals) in Zingibar district. The majority of assisted IDPs have been displaced in a duration between one week to a month.

Al Maharah: IOM provided EESKs to 600 IDP families (4,200 individuals) in Al-Ghaidha district.

Aden: UNHCR distributed NFIs to 476 newly displaced families (2,437 individuals) in different districts of Aden governorate. Other 14 families residing in Al-Sha'b collective center were provided with EESKs. UNHCR provided rental subsidies to 130 IDP families (910 individuals) in Dar Sa'd district (Aden) and 80 IDP families (560 individuals) in Tuban district (Lahj).

Lahj: The Response Network - Aden assisted 40 IDP families (280 individuals) in Tuban district, Lahj with cash assistance in lieu for rehabilitation of their damaged houses. This assistance allowed these families to rehabilitate a part of their own house and restart their lives in some dignity.

Shabwah: SHS provided NFIs to 200 families (1,400 individuals) and cash assistance for rental subsidies to 400 families (2,800 individuals) in Ataq district.

